

Day-60 Report — Stabilize, Stand Up, Win

James D. Codling, PE · Days 31-60: August 13 – September 11, 2026 · Prepared for Drew Wheatlake, CEO & Brad Geer, President & COO

THE HEADLINE

Three of four Day-60 commitments are complete, the fourth is in progress, two 90-day hires are already on the floor, and the division now runs on a real operating system — resource-loaded P6 schedules, a pursuit pipeline ready to receive Estimating on day one, auto-generated dashboards, and a documented capital-delivery process (full inventory below). The pursuit gate got its first real test: MEC VanMeter 161kV was scoped end-to-end under the new structure, then **no-goed on the merits** — estimating hours preserved for better-fit work. The two Day-30 decisions — the VP pursuit hire and moving Estimating into CVR — remain the gate on growth.

Day-60 commitments 3 / 4 complete · QA/QC gates in progress	Hires started 2 Senior PM 8/24 · Trans. Designer 9/7	First pursuit-gate decision No-go VanMeter — discipline over volume	Backlog \$866K +30% Consumers ramp into year-end	Utilization (thru 8/8) 54.0% vs 75% target — 638 hrs in bids
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DAY-60 SCORECARD — WHAT WAS COMMITTED vs WHAT WAS DELIVERED

Commitment (due)	Status	Delivered — evidence
Stand up pipeline tracking & win-rate baseline (8/22)	DONE	Delivered at Day 30, now operationalized: every pursuit runs a standard estimate cycle (go/no-go through submit) in the CVR-PURSUIT P6 schedule, resource-loaded, with bid-date float on the program dashboard. Win rate holds at 69% (2026) vs 50% (2025).
Convert one anchor reconnect into a scoped pursuit (9/6)	DONE	Exceeded. Consumers pole program is booked work (\$274.7K PO, backlog into Jan-27) ramping +30% into year-end. VanMeter was scoped end-to-end under the new structure, then no-goed at the gate — conversion discipline working in both directions.
Establish design QA/QC review gates (9/1)	IN PROGRESS	Gates authored into CVR-PROC-001 Rev 0: design-check steps by classification, engineer-verified procurement, and engineering-complete-by dates enforced per element in the P6 master schedule. Rollout across active jobs underway; full adoption rides Decision 2.
Open priority engineering reqs — TE/DE leads (8/27)	DONE	T-line, substation, and structural reqs open and recruiting; Senior PM started 8/24, Transmission Designer 9/7; JD library written for all ten classifications with a defined experience / PE-EIT ladder; VP EPC Project Development one-pager ready on Decision 1.

THE OPERATING SYSTEM STOOD UP IN DAYS 31-60 — TOOLS & PROCESSES

Tool / process	What it does for the business
P6 master schedule (CVR-MASTER)	Every piece of CVR work — EPC supporting HWC plus direct CenterPoint — in one resource-loaded schedule: engineering-complete-by dates per element, material procurement, and a long-lead register by equipment class. Exposed that most jobs need early material release — New Baltimore's rolling batch-1 release is the template.
P6 pursuit pipeline (CVR-PURSUIT)	Standard estimate-cycle template per pursuit with bid-date constraints and estimating resources loaded — plus an Intake Sheet so Estimating's entire backlog loads in one pass the day it moves into CVR. The receiving infrastructure for Decision 2 is already built.
Program dashboard (auto-generated)	One page from the live schedules: program timeline, bid float, long-lead procurement margins, and month-by-month delivery-vs-pursuit resource stacking. Regenerates on every schedule update; BI-ready.
Financial model + dashboard + deck	Driver-based three-scenario forecast reconciled to Budget V5, monthly KPI dashboard (8/8 package live), and the 25-slide review deck — market, national footprint, at-scale EPC model (\$150M/yr → ~\$7.6M CVR OI), win-accumulation economics, and the ask.
Estimating platform selection	Weighted scorecard across candidates: B2W is the demo-verified front-runner; one vendor eliminated on a gate fail. Closure items defined (pricing/TCO, egress, SOC 2, references) plus a parallel bid test on a closed CenterPoint job. Sage stays through transition; read-only Sage extraction doubles as the migration path.
Systems & licensure groundwork	Stay on P6 desktop (~\$2-3K/yr vs an \$8-13K OPC floor; revisit at 5+ users). COINS read-only scoped-extract request framed for IT. Licensure runway mapped: MI firm registration, FL registry (no COA), GA covered by Jim's GA PE.

AHEAD OF SCHEDULE — 90-DAY ITEMS ALREADY DELIVERED OR IN MOTION

Committed item (original due)	Plan	Where it stands at Day 60
Close two engineering hires (10/6)	90-day	Done — both closed and started. Senior PM on board 8/24 (delivery + program management for the EPC-paired backlog); Transmission Designer on board 9/7 (capacity against the Consumers ramp).
Submit first major proposal under new structure (10/3)	90-day	In motion. VanMeter was fully scoped under the sub-management EPC model before the no-go — the structure is proven and reusable, DTE Renaissance 345kV now carries the flag; Lansing BWL remains the biggest Q4 swing (\$1.35M).
Draft 12-month growth & hiring plan (10/1)	90-day	Substantially complete. The review deck carries the growth thesis end-to-end — addressable market, target-utility expansion (AEP, FirstEnergy, PG&E, Southern), at-scale model, hiring sequence — and the JD library makes the hiring plan executable.
Present 90-day results & revised forecast (10/11)	90-day	Machinery live, waiting on actuals. Forecast-vs-actual cadence is built; July and August closes are still pending from finance — the only blocker to running it.

DECISIONS — TWO CARRIED, TWO NEW

Decision	Case
1 · Fund the VP, EPC Project Development hire (carried from Day 30)	~\$400K/yr all-in against warm AEP + FirstEnergy relationships. Every month unfunded is pipeline the at-scale model can't originate; one mid-size EPC award returns the year-one cost. Candidate identified; one-pager in hand.
2 · Approve CVR-PROC-001 — move Estimating into CVR (carried from Day 30)	Now de-risked: the pursuit schedule, intake sheet, and dashboard are built and waiting — Estimating's backlog loads in one pass on day one. The long-lead register makes the case quantitatively: engineering-complete dates only hold with unified early material release, which requires one pursuit-and-delivery process.
3 · Authorize the estimating-platform close-out (new)	Approve running the selection to conclusion: pricing/TCO, references, security review, and the parallel bid test on a closed CenterPoint job. Decision-ready package returns in the 90-day window; no platform commitment until the test scores.
4 · Back the finance-data asks (new)	Two small unlocks: (a) COINS read-only scoped extracts (GL, job cost, AR served from existing BI views — least-privilege, no payroll detail) so the model runs on actuals without manual pulls; (b) the CFO decision on bid-engineering accounting — intercompany bid-support billing recommended.

WATCH ITEMS — SAID PLAINLY

- **Utilization is 54.0% vs the 75% target** (through 8/8), with 638 unbilled hours in bids — the accounting fix (Decision 4b) and September submittals converting to backlog are the levers.
- **July and August closes are outstanding** — until finance lands them, H2 tracks on operational KPIs only and the re-forecast can't be validated against actuals.
- **Long-lead exposure:** without early material release, engineering-complete margins go negative on nearly every scheduled job — a process decision (Decision 2), not a scheduling problem.
- **Close-outs need replacement work:** multiple jobs complete by Oct-26, and the VanMeter no-go removed ~\$305K of expected value from coverage — Renaissance, Lansing BWL, and new go decisions are the fill. This is the Decision 1 case in one line.

DAYS 61-90 — SCALE, HIRE, ACQUIRE

- **Win what's in market:** press Renaissance, Lansing BWL, and the Q4 slate; backfill the VanMeter coverage gap with new go decisions.
- **Convert capacity to revenue:** ramp both new hires to billable; fill the open T-line / substation / structural reqs from the JD library; per-person utilization plans against 75%.
- **Execute the platform test:** run the parallel bid test and return the estimating-platform recommendation with real numbers.
- **Close the loop on actuals:** August + September closes into the forecast-vs-actual cadence; COINS extracts on Decision 4.
- **Day-90 presentation:** results, revised forecast, and the formal 12-month growth & hiring plan.

Bottom line: the stabilization phase did its job — the team is bigger, the pursuit engine is disciplined enough to say no, and the division now runs on schedules and dashboards instead of memory. The 90-day phase converts that machinery into wins and hires. Decisions 1 and 2 are still the gate, and both are cheaper to say yes to than they were thirty days ago.